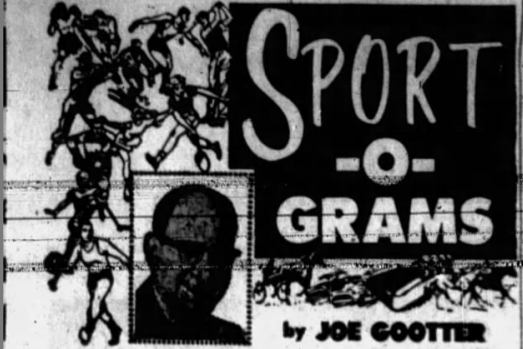




# SPORT -O- GRAMS

by JOE GOOTTER

Tommy Byrne's retirement from baseball must mark the end of an era. The 38-year-old New York Yankee left-hander announced yesterday that he has hung up his uniform and while he didn't say "Positively," his intentions seem inclined to the Exits.

The colorful pitcher from Wake Forest has been around for many years now and apparently his downhill slide last season, served as the convincer in his retirement decision. He appeared in 30 games during the campaign and had a record of 4 wins against 6 losses, with an earned run average of 4.36. Those figures don't add up as reason for jubilation, especially to somebody who's been around as long as Tommy. He's been up there for 14 years.

So, Byrne decided to step out, explaining that he plans to devote all his attention to an oil business in North Carolina. The veteran hurler will be missed. He always was a tough man to beat, especially when his control was right. He wasn't a fast man in getting around to throwing the ball but once he did, it was fast enough.

The major leaguers open the 1958 baseball action today, with all 16 competing in exhibition games on various sun-baked (they hope!) fronts.

When the exhibition season begins, can Spring be far behind? The odds are you come up with an affirmative answer.

One of my columnist colleagues in another city, owner of quite a sense of humor, ran a piece saying he didn't think much of the dog selected "best in show" at the Westminster event. He might have escaped unscathed for that comment, but he really stuck his neck out by flatly writing that he didn't like dogs.

A ton of mail, topping all previous records for him, poured in and the scribe indicated which-way the wind would blow for him in the future when he declared: "Now, I don't like water buffaloes."

He thinks he's safe with that one but isn't completely sure yet.

Mike Bauchley who was in charge of G.I. recruiting in Passaic a couple of years ago, has retired after twenty years of Army life and reported that he recently met some former Jersey sport figures in California. These included Abie Bain, boxer out of Newark and active on Hollywood movie lots for some-time.

In the south, before heading for the West Coast, Mike saw Joey Greb, former Herkimer, N. Y. boxer and Andy Cohen, former ballplayer who now is teaching rookies at Miller Huggins Field, St. Petersburg, Fla. Regards from Bauchley were conveyed by note to Paul Cavaliere, Carl and Lou Duva, Abe Greene, Ad Stone, Angelo Pucci, Bill Daly, and Mike's brother, George who is a Fair Lawn resident.

Paterson product Eddie Einhorn has organized a sports-packaging service in Chicago, providing programs for radio stations. Eddie who is managing director of this programming plan and who will broadcast games as part of the package, was sports director of the University of Pennsylvania radio station and also was announcer for an Evanston, Illinois station.